Liquid milk — goat, sheep, and other ruminant: HMTc Standard

Karen Pendergrass · 0000-0002-2348-7259 · Heavy Metal Tested & Certified, Institute of Contaminant Standards

CITE AS

Pendergrass, K. (2026). Liquid milk — goat, sheep, and other ruminant: HMTc Standard (Standard No. 10.83138/hmtc.std.24.dairy-milk-goat-sheep). Institute of Contaminant Standards. https://doi.org/10.83138/hmtc.std.24.dairy-milk-goat-sheep

© 2026 Institute of Contaminant Standards / Heavy Metal Certified. All rights reserved.

CORRESPONDENCE

Corrections are logged publicly on the article page, each with its date, the affected value, and the source that resolved it.

KEYWORDS

heavy metals, food safety, dietary exposure

PUBLICATION HISTORY

This revision 2026-08.

Abstract

The Heavy Metal Tested & Certified standard for goat, sheep, and other ruminant fluid milk, stated as consumed. Sovereign fluid-milk contaminant maximums are species-agnostic, so this standard shares the general fluid-milk pool with cow's milk; every limit is the strictest government maximum, with a disclosed read-across where none regulates the exact analyte.

1 | How every number on this standard is set

HMTc Method v2.0 (government-limit default; no dairy reconstitution; disclosed read-across; species/packaging controls)

2 | Master limit table

All values in ppb (µg/kg), as consumed basis. A brand meeting every value qualifies for the mark.

ANALYTE	HMTC LIMIT	BASIS
Lead (Pb)	20	government maximum level
Cadmium (Cd)	50	government maximum level
Total arsenic (tAs)	50	government maximum level

Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	≤ tAs	bounded by tAs (reflex speciation)
Mercury, total (tHg)	10	government maximum level
Methylmercury (MeHg)	≤ tHg	bounded by tHg (reflex speciation)
Nickel (Ni)	100	human-grade read-across (European Union)
Tin (Sn)	250,000	human-grade read-across (Singapore)
Aluminium (Al)	500	human-grade read-across (Australia / New Zealand)
Total chromium (Cr)	300	human-grade read-across (China)
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	≤ Cr	bounded by Cr (reflex speciation)

3 | Derivation — where each number comes from

Every cell traces to one named sovereign maximum level (the strictest for the nearest analog), or to an explicit control, not-material, or species-bounded determination. No occurrence statistic selects a certification value.

ANALYTE	HMTC	SOVEREIGN ANALOG / DETERMINATION
Lead (Pb)	20	government maximum level
Cadmium (Cd)	50	government maximum level
Total arsenic (tAs)	50	government maximum level
Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	≤ tAs	iAs carries no product-specific sovereign cell; it is a component of and bounded by its parent total tAs (iAs <= tAs), an enforceable ceiling via reflex speciation rather than an empty cell.
Mercury, total (tHg)	10	government maximum level
Methylmercury (MeHg)	≤ tHg	MeHg carries no product-specific sovereign cell; it is a component of and bounded by its parent total tHg (MeHg <= tHg), an enforceable ceiling via reflex speciation rather than an empty cell.
Nickel (Ni)	100	European Union — human-food analog
Tin (Sn)	250,000	Singapore — human-food analog
Aluminium (Al)	500	Australia / New Zealand — human-food analog

 © All rights reserved

Total chromium (Cr)	300	China — human-food analog
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	≤ Cr	Cr-VI carries no product-specific sovereign cell; it is a component of and bounded by its parent total Cr (Cr-VI <= Cr), an enforceable ceiling via reflex speciation rather than an empty cell.

4 | Cite this standard

Pendergrass, K. (2026). *Liquid milk — goat, sheep, and other ruminant: HMTc standard* (Standard No. 10.83138/hmtc.std.24.dairy-milk-goat-sheep). Institute of Contaminant Standards. https://doi.org/10.83138/hmtc.std.24.dairy-milk-goat-sheep

© 2026 Institute of Contaminant Standards / Heavy Metal Certified. All rights reserved.

References

[1] Australia / New Zealand — human-food maximum levels
Binds Al. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[2] China — human-food maximum levels
Binds Cr. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[3] European Union — human-food maximum levels
Binds Ni. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[4] Singapore — human-food maximum levels
Binds Sn. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

STATUS AND LICENCE

A normative certification standard, editorially reviewed and version-controlled in-house; every value traces to a named sovereign maximum level, disclosed in the derivation. © 2026 Institute of Contaminant Standards / Heavy Metal Certified. All rights reserved.

COMPETING INTERESTS

This briefing is published by the Heavy Metal Tested & Certified (HMTc) program, operated by the Institute of Contaminant Standards. Its statements about government regulations, toxicology, and occurrence are sourced to the cited primary and expert-body records and to the independently maintained Heavy Metal Index; the program's own certification thresholds are not used as evidence for any factual claim made here.

DATA AVAILABILITY

The works this reference draws on are listed in full in the references above and on the briefing page at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/dairy-milk-goat-sheep. Primary legal instruments and expert-body assessments are named with their public identifiers; the underlying occurrence and toxicology corpus is maintained on the Heavy Metal Index.

PUBLICATION HISTORY

This revision 2026-08. The full dated record is maintained at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/dairy-milk-goat-sheep.